

KSM · HONEST INVENTORY · 15 AUGUST 2026

PRISM & POLLEN

There is no manuscript yet.

The GitHub repo is empty. Notion's NOVEL page is blank.
No autobiography exists in Slack, Twilda, or this workspace.

What you do have: Cardinal and Dawn — a finished history project —
and Trinity Book II, a fictional first-person frame.

This pack is the inventory, the Cardinal lock, and Claude prompts
that refuse to invent your life.

Cardinal.pdf and Dawn.pdf already live on GitHub:
github.com/kylesmcauliffe/cardinal

INVENTORY

What I looked for

You asked for the same treatment as Trinity: gather everything on Prism and Pollen, or anything autobiographical, and make a PDF plus Claude prompts.

Prism and Pollen is an empty GitHub repo. Four commits, all access tests. The README is one line. Notion's 2023 page titled NOVEL is blank. Slack, Twilda, Codex, Aftercare, Canva, and this workspace have no pollen, prism, memoir, or autobiography manuscript.

If the book is in Notes, Voice Memos, Google Docs, or a hard drive, it is not connected to me. I will not invent it.

Public facts only

These are the only biographical facts I will lock. Everything else is a gap.

- Kyle McAuliffe / KSM
- Founder and editor of Artometrics — data-science magazine for creative industries and culture
- Writes long-form reports from public datasets
- Author of Cardinal: The Stanford Corridor and Dawn: An American Odyssey
- Also building Twilda, Aftercare, KSM (zine), Rainfall Health / Stratus
- artometrics.com

No childhood, family, schools, or private scenes exist in the connected record.

CARDINAL

The writing you actually have

Cardinal — The Stanford Corridor

A finished narrative-nonfiction book. Not a memoir. Download: github.com/kylesmcauliffe/cardinal → Cardinal.pdf

A forty-mile Peninsula corridor has been the controlling position in the American economy for well over a century. Stanford is the secret heart of California. The garage story is a theodicy.

The mechanism, in every era:

- Chokepoint control
- Public subsidy converted into private monopoly
- Elite network reproduction

Four questions every chapter: who controls the inputs, who captures the surplus, who is excluded, how the system reproduces.

Voice: Michael Lewis meets Guns, Germs, and Steel. Confident, not arrogant. Specificity as drama. Not academic, not hagiographic, not conspiratorial, not breathless. Gravity is not a conspiracy. Opens on Galvez Street. Ends on the 2025 inauguration platform.

Four acts

- I — Land, Monopoly, and Institution
- II — Hoover, War, and the Archive State
- III — The Silicon Valley Machine
- IV — The Open Era

Dawn — An American Odyssey

Companion volume. Old-world deep history to the eve of the American conquest of California. Dawn.pdf is on the same repo. Read Dawn for origins; Cardinal stands alone for the argument.

Trinity Book II

The only first-person life frame on disk — and it is fiction. KSM as Don Quixote: wrote Trinity, thought it unpublishable, tries to live it. Do not treat that as a CV.

PROPOSAL

A possible map (not canon)

Suggested jobs for the four titles. Confirm or reject before writing.

- Dawn — deep history, the old world's pattern
- Cardinal — the American / Stanford / corridor argument (already drafted)
- Prism and Pollen — the missing first-person book
- Trinity — fiction that metabolizes the same material

A prompt, not a found note: prism = how light splits, analysis, seeing the corridor. Pollen = what fertilizes — chance, bodies, work, the unchosen.

PROMPTS

Claude — how to start

Full copy-paste prompts are in `claude-prompts.md` in this folder. The rule that matters: do not invent a life.

- 1 — Interview me, one question at a time
- 2 — Title hearing: five possible jobs for Prism and Pollen
- 3 — Object-method skeleton (Cardinal's method, first person, all objects blank)
- 4 — Blank life timeline with [YOU FILL] cells
- 5 — First chapter with gaps showing
- 6 — Voice split: Cardinal public vs I
- 7 — Braid or don't (Cardinal / Dawn / Trinity)
- 8-11 — Cardinal continuation, pitch, Galvez exercise, Dawn handoff
- 12 — Work diary from a week you paste
- 13 — KSM zine image prompts
- 14 — Continue from a memory or Cardinal passage you paste

One-liner: Do not invent my life. Public facts only unless I pasted it. Cardinal is history, not memoir. Prism and Pollen is empty — interview or [YOU FILL].

LINKS

Where to get the real books

These already exist. You do not need me to rebuild them.

- Cardinal.pdf — github.com/kylesmcauliffe/cardinal/blob/main/Cardinal.pdf
- Dawn.pdf — github.com/kylesmcauliffe/cardinal/blob/main/Dawn.pdf
- Cardinal source — [books/cardinal/](#) (preface, introduction, four acts)
- Voice bible — [books/cardinal/_project/voice.md](#)
- Thesis — [books/cardinal/_project/thesis.md](#)

This inventory lives in the `prismandpollen` repo so you can download it the same way as the Trinity pack: open the pull request, Files changed.